

brings the biggest visual refresh since iOS 7. The new 'Liquid Glass' design revamps icons and makes the lock screen more dynamic with widgets. You can safely count on the iPhone 17 Pro Max getting at least five years of major iOS updates, maybe more.

As for Apple Intelligence, the iPhone 17 Pro Max doesn't bring the full suite just yet. The highlight is Live Translation, which works across iPhones and AirPods in select languages (English, French, German, Portuguese, Spanish, with more to come). For now, it's restricted to English-speaking regions. Visual Intelligence can analyse photos and fetch search results, while the Photos app gains smarter object removal tools.

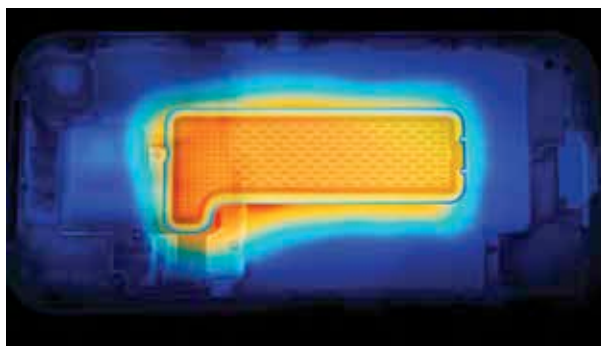
CAMERAS

The rear camera system features three 48MP sensors: primary, ultra-wide, and telephoto with 4x optical zoom. On paper, that's a step down from last year's 5x, but image quality has improved across the range. The results speak for themselves: sharper detail, richer colours, and more improved low-light performance. Even zoomed shots up to 8x look really solid. Beyond that, digital zoom loses detail.

The 18MP selfie camera is a big upgrade too, offering both wide and standard perspectives. The new Centre Stage system uses a square sensor, so you can shoot in portrait or landscape regardless of orientation, with some digital zoom flexibility as well.

In ideal conditions, the iPhone 17 Pro Max delivers stunning photos with accurate colours and incredibly crisp detail. Low light can sometimes crush shadows, but the results are still top-tier. Portrait mode, especially at 4x zoom, looks excellent.

Video, as always, is Apple's strongest suit. You can record 4K HDR at multiple



frame rates (24, 30, 60, 120fps), Cinematic Mode at 4K 30, and Action Mode at 2.8K 60. ProRes recording goes up to 4K 120fps with external storage. The new GenLock feature syncs multiple cameras for professional workflows. I haven't tested it myself, but for those who need it, it's a big deal.

All said, footage shot on the iPhone 17 Pro Max simply looks fantastic. It is sharper, smoother, and more flexible than what its rivals offer, even if they tout 8K capture.

BATTERY AND CHARGING

Battery life is finally where it should be. The 4,823mAh unit (5,088mAh in the US) easily delivers a day and a half. In my testing, I got 36 hours with 8.5 hours of screen-on time, still leaving 25% in the tank. Light users can push it to two days. In our 1080p video loop test, the phone lasted an astounding 25.9 hours.

Charging is respectable too. The iPhone 17 Pro Max supports 40W fast wired charging and 25W fast wireless charging. With a 150W PD 3.0 charger, the device went from 0 to 100% in 62 minutes. That's not the absolute fastest in the industry, but combined with the

excellent battery life, it's more than enough.

VERDICT

The iPhone 17 Pro Max is the kind of device that reminds you why Apple still sits at the top of the smartphone market. It nails the basics: display, performance, battery, cameras, and then adds layers of polish that make it feel truly special. From the new design and cooling system to the advanced camera tools and iOS 26, everything comes together seamlessly.

But let's not sugar-coat it: this phone is expensive. Starting at Rs 1,59,900 and going all the way to Rs 2,29,900, it's not a device most people can justify buying. For the majority, the iPhone 17 itself is the smarter choice, especially now

that it has a 120Hz display, similar base storage as the Pro models, same 18MP selfie camera and the list goes on.

However, if you're someone who wants the best iPhone money can buy, whether you're a creator, a gamer, or just someone who values having the absolute top-end Apple experience, the iPhone 17 Pro Max is unmatched. It's not perfect, but it's the closest Apple has come in years.

—Aman Rashid

SPECIFICATIONS

Processor: Apple A19 Pro | GPU: 6-core Apple GPU | RAM: 12 GB LPDDR5X | Storage 256GB, 512GB, 1TB, 2TB NVMe | OS: iOS 26 | Display: 6.9-inch LTPO OLED Super Retina XDR display, 2868 x 1320 pixels, HDR10, Dolby Vision | Refresh Rate: 1-120 Hz Adaptive | IP Rating: IP68 | Cameras: 48 MP (primary) + 48 MP (telephoto) + 48MP (ultra-wide) | Selfie Camera: 18 MP Centre Stage | Video: Up to 4K at 120 fps | Battery Capacity: 4,823 mAh | Charging: 40W (wired), 25W (wireless)

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